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Question

An analysis by Alain Elayi and colleagues of coins minted in Sidon in the fifth and fourth centuries BCE reveals a change in their composition over time: while a coin from circa 450 BCE contains about 98% silver and 1% copper, a coin from 367 BCE (the end of Ba'alšillem II's reign) contains 74.2% silver and 24.7% copper, giving it a relatively yellowish appearance that traders would have noticed. Because coins with a silver content below 80% were widely considered unsuitable for trade, Elayi et al. speculate that a crisis in confidence in the currency occurred in Sidon around 367 BCE, which was likely relieved—despite Sidon's persistent oppressive financial obligations—as a result of Ba'alšillem II's successor Abd'aštart I's decision to ______

Which choice most logically completes the text?

Answer

A. proclaim that the percentage of silver in coins suitable for trade would be raised to a threshold higher than 80%.

B. keep the amount of silver in Sidonian coins consistent with that in coins minted in 367 BCE but decrease their weight.

C. begin minting heavier coins with a proportion of silver to copper similar to that in coins minted in 367 BCE.

D. fund the mining of some copper deposits that were not available to Ba'alšillem II.